

Benefits Overview

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- Enrollment: benefits.apextech.com

Table of Contents

1. Benefits Eligibility
2. Health Insurance
3. Dental & Vision
4. Retirement Savings (401k)
5. Life & Disability Insurance
6. Paid Time Off
7. Parental Leave
8. Professional Development
9. Wellness Programs
10. Additional Perks
11. Enrollment & Changes

Benefits Eligibility

Full-Time Employees

Eligible for all benefits outlined in this document.

- Regular full-time status (40 hours/week)
- Benefits effective first of month following start date
- Example: Start date Feb 15 → Benefits active March 1

Part-Time Employees

Pro-rated benefits based on hours worked:

- PTO: Pro-rated based on schedule
- Health insurance: Available if working 30+ hours/week
- 401(k): Eligible immediately
- Other benefits: Varies (discuss with HR)

Contractors/Temporary Workers

Not eligible for company benefits.

- May purchase individual health insurance
- Not eligible for PTO, 401(k) employer match, etc.

Dependents Eligible for Coverage

- Legal spouse or domestic partner
- Children up to age 26
- Disabled dependents (no age limit with proper documentation)

Health Insurance

ApexTech offers comprehensive medical coverage through **Blue Cross Blue Shield**.

Plan Options (2026)

Option 1: PPO Plan (Preferred Provider Organization)

Best for: Flexibility, frequent medical needs

Premiums (monthly, employee portion):

- Employee only: \$120
- Employee + Spouse: \$280
- Employee + Child(ren): \$260
- Family: \$380

Coverage:

- In-network deductible: \$500 individual / \$1,000 family
- Out-of-network deductible: \$1,500 individual / \$3,000 family
- Co-insurance: 80/20 (plan pays 80%)
- Out-of-pocket max: \$3,000 individual / \$6,000 family
- Primary care visit: \$25 copay
- Specialist visit: \$50 copay
- Urgent care: \$75 copay
- ER visit: \$250 copay

Advantages:

- See any doctor (in or out of network)
- No referrals needed for specialists
- Broad provider network

Option 2: HDHP (High Deductible Health Plan) with HSA

Best for: Healthy individuals, want to save on premiums

Premiums (monthly, employee portion):

- Employee only: \$60
- Employee + Spouse: \$160
- Employee + Child(ren): \$140
- Family: \$220

Coverage:

- Deductible: \$1,500 individual / \$3,000 family
- Co-insurance: 80/20 after deductible
- Out-of-pocket max: \$5,000 individual / \$10,000 family

- Preventive care: \$0 (covered 100%)
- All other services: Pay deductible first, then 80/20

HSA (Health Savings Account):

- Company contributes: \$750/year (employee only) or \$1,500/year (family)
- You can contribute additional (2026 limits: \$4,150 individual / \$8,300 family)
- Tax-free contributions, growth, and withdrawals (for medical expenses)
- Funds roll over year to year (you keep it even if you leave)
- Can invest HSA funds like a 401(k)

Advantages:

- Lower premiums
- Tax-advantaged HSA savings
- Good for healthy individuals

What's Covered (Both Plans)

Preventive Care (100% covered, no deductible):

- Annual physical exams
- Immunizations
- Screenings (cancer, diabetes, cholesterol)
- Well-child visits
- Annual OB-GYN exams

Medical Services:

- Hospital stays
- Surgery and procedures
- Emergency care
- Lab work and X-rays
- Mental health services
- Prescription drugs (see below)

Prescription Drug Coverage:

- Generic: \$10 copay
- Preferred brand: \$30 copay
- Non-preferred brand: \$60 copay
- Specialty drugs: 20% coinsurance (up to \$200/month)
- Mail-order pharmacy: 90-day supply for 2× copay

Finding Providers

Provider Search: bcbs.com/find-a-doctor

- Enter ZIP code
- Filter by "ApexTech Solutions" plan
- Check if in-network (lower costs)

Telemedicine:

- MDLIVE available 24/7
- Video/phone consultations
- \$0 copay for PPO, \$49 for HDHP (before deductible met)
- Prescriptions sent to your pharmacy

Dental & Vision

Dental Insurance (Delta Dental)

Premium (monthly, employee portion):

- Employee only: \$15
- Employee + dependents: \$40

Coverage:

- **Preventive** (cleanings, exams, X-rays): 100% covered, no deductible
- **Basic** (fillings, extractions): 80% covered after \$50 deductible
- **Major** (crowns, bridges, dentures): 50% covered after \$50 deductible
- **Orthodontia** (braces): 50% covered (up to \$1,500 lifetime max)

Annual Maximum Benefit: \$2,000 per person

Cleanings: 2 per year covered 100%

Vision Insurance (VSP)

Premium (monthly, employee portion):

- Employee only: \$8
- Employee + dependents: \$20

Coverage (every 12 months):

- **Eye exam:** \$10 copay
- **Lenses:** \$25 copay (single, bifocal, or progressive)
- **Frames:** \$130 allowance (20% discount beyond)
- **Contacts:** \$130 allowance (instead of glasses)

Laser Vision Correction (LASIK/PRK):

- 15% discount through VSP providers

Find Providers: vsp.com

Retirement Savings (401k)

Plan Overview

ApexTech offers a 401(k) retirement savings plan through **Fidelity**.

Eligibility:

- Immediate (enroll on day 1)
- All employees (full-time and part-time)

Company Match

Generous employer match to help you save:

- ApexTech matches **100% of first 6%** you contribute
- Example: You contribute 6% of salary → Company adds another 6%
- Vest immediately (it's your money from day 1)

Example:

- Salary: \$100,000
- You contribute: 6% = \$6,000
- Company match: 6% = \$6,000
- **Total annual contribution: \$12,000**

Contribution Limits (2026)

- **Employee contribution limit:** \$23,500/year
- **Age 50+ catch-up:** Additional \$7,500
- **Total limit** (employee + employer): \$70,000

Investment Options

- **Target Date Funds:** Automatic rebalancing based on retirement year
- **Index Funds:** Low-cost broad market exposure (S&P; 500, Total Market)
- **Bond Funds:** Lower risk, steady returns
- **International Funds:** Global diversification
- **Company Stock:** Option to invest in ApexTech (limit: 10% of portfolio)

Free Financial Advisory:

Fidelity provides free consultations with financial advisors (in-person or phone). Highly recommended!

Roth 401(k) Option

Traditional vs. Roth:

- **Traditional:** Pre-tax contributions (reduces taxable income now), taxed in retirement
- **Roth:** After-tax contributions (no tax benefit now), tax-free withdrawals in retirement
- **Can split** between both

Who should choose Roth?

- Younger employees (expect higher tax bracket in retirement)
- Want tax-free growth and withdrawals

Accessing Your 401(k)

- **Portal:** netbenefits.com
- **Mobile app:** Fidelity Mobile
- **Customer service:** 1-800-343-3548

Loans & Withdrawals:

- Can borrow up to 50% of balance (repay with interest)
- Hardship withdrawals available (medical, housing, education)
- Early withdrawal penalty: 10% + taxes (if under 59½)

Life & Disability Insurance

Basic Life Insurance (Company-Paid)

Coverage: 1× annual salary

- No cost to you
- Automatic enrollment
- Beneficiary designation required

Example:

- Salary: \$80,000 → Coverage: \$80,000 payout to beneficiary

Supplemental Life Insurance (Employee-Paid, Optional)

Additional coverage available for purchase:

- Employee: Up to 5× salary (max \$500,000)
- Spouse: Up to \$250,000
- Child: \$10,000 per child

Rates: Based on age, typically \$0.20-\$0.50 per \$1,000 coverage

When to Add:

- Have dependents
- Mortgage or large debts
- Want to ensure family is financially secure

Short-Term Disability (Company-Paid)

Covers: Injury or illness preventing you from working

- **Benefit:** 60% of salary
- **Waiting period:** 14 days
- **Duration:** Up to 90 days
- Examples: Surgery recovery, serious illness, pregnancy complications

Long-Term Disability (Company-Paid)

Covers: Extended disability beyond 90 days

- **Benefit:** 60% of salary
- **Duration:** Until age 65 or recovery
- **Waiting period:** 90 days (after short-term ends)
- Examples: Chronic illness, severe injury

Supplemental LTD (Employee-Paid):

Option to increase benefit to 70% of salary.

Paid Time Off

Vacation Days

Annual Entitlement: 20 days

- Accrues monthly (1.67 days/month)
- Can carry over up to 10 days
- See HR Policies for full details

Sick Leave

Annual Entitlement: 10 days

- For illness, medical appointments, family care
- Does not roll over
- See HR Policies for details

Holidays (2026)

11 Company-Paid Holidays:

- New Year's Day
- MLK Jr. Day
- Presidents' Day
- Memorial Day
- Independence Day
- Labor Day
- Thanksgiving (+ day after)
- Christmas Eve (half day)
- Christmas Day
- New Year's Eve (half day)
- 2 Floating holidays (your choice)

Summer Fridays (June 1 - Aug 31):

Leave at 3:00 PM on Fridays (no PTO needed)

Bereavement Leave

5 paid days for death of immediate family member

- Immediate family: Spouse, child, parent, sibling, grandparent
- Extended family (aunt, uncle, cousin): 1-2 days (manager discretion)
- Additional unpaid leave available if needed

Jury Duty & Voting

- **Jury duty:** Fully paid (provide notice to manager)
- **Voting:** Flexible time off to vote (2 hours paid)

Parental Leave

Maternity Leave

18 weeks fully paid for birthing parent

- Use before and/or after birth
- Can extend with accrued PTO
- Short-term disability may apply (see benefits)

Paternity Leave

6 weeks fully paid for non-birthing parent

- Can be taken anytime within first 6 months
- Can extend with accrued PTO

Adoption Leave

12 weeks fully paid for adoptive parents

- For children under age 6
- Can be split between parents or taken together

Flexible Return

Gradual return options:

- Part-time schedule for first 4 weeks (full pay)
- Work-from-home flexibility
- Adjusted meeting schedules

Lactation Support:

- Private lactation rooms on every floor
- Flexible breaks for pumping
- Breast pump provided (through insurance)

New Parent Resources:

- \$500 stipend for baby gear
- Access to parenting support groups
- Backup childcare benefit (see Additional Perks)

Professional Development

Annual Stipend: \$1,500

Use for:

- Courses and certifications
- Conference attendance (registration + travel)
- Professional books and subscriptions
- Coaching and mentorship programs
- Association memberships

See Expense Policy for full details.

Educational Assistance

Degree Programs:

- Company reimburses up to **\$10,000/year** for approved degree programs
- Must be job-related (Bachelor's, Master's, PhD)
- Requires manager + VP approval
- GPA requirement: 3.0 minimum
- Commitment: Repay if leave within 1 year of completion

Eligible Programs:

- Computer Science, Engineering
- Business Administration (MBA)
- Data Science, Analytics
- Design, Marketing
- Other job-relevant degrees

Internal Learning

- **ApexTech Academy:** Free internal courses
- **Lunch & Learns:** Weekly sessions
- **Mentorship Program:** Paired with senior employees
- **Leadership Development:** Emerging Leaders cohort program

Wellness Programs

Fitness & Wellness**Gym Membership Subsidy:**

- \$50/month towards gym membership
- Submit receipts monthly via Expensify

On-Site Fitness:

- Gym access in SF HQ (free for employees)
- Yoga and meditation classes (weekly)
- Standing desks and treadmill desks available

Wellness Reimbursement:

- \$200/year for wellness expenses
- Examples: Fitness classes, massage, meditation apps, sports equipment
- Submit receipts via HR Portal

Mental Health Support**Employee Assistance Program (EAP):**

- Free confidential counseling (6 sessions/year)
- 24/7 crisis support hotline
- Mental health, financial, legal advice
- Work-life balance coaching

Mental Health Days:

- Use sick leave for mental health (no questions asked)
- Encouraged to prioritize mental wellbeing

Therapy Coverage:

- Mental health fully covered under medical insurance
- In-network therapist: \$25 copay (PPO) or subject to deductible (HDHP)
- Telemedicine therapy available

Preventive Care Initiatives

Annual Health Screening:

- Biometric screening offered on-site (free)
- Know your numbers: Blood pressure, cholesterol, glucose, BMI
- Incentive: \$100 wellness credit for participating

Flu Shots:

- Free on-site flu clinic every fall
- Encouraged for all employees

Healthy Snacks:

- Fresh fruit, nuts, healthy snacks in office
- Filtered water and coffee (free)

Additional Perks

Commuter Benefits

Pre-Tax Commuter Savings:

- Up to \$315/month for transit (bus, train, subway)
- Up to \$315/month for parking
- Save ~30% via pre-tax deductions

How It Works:

- Elect amount via benefits portal
- Funds deducted pre-tax from paycheck
- Use for eligible commuter expenses

Alternatives:

- **Bike to Work:** \$25/month for bike maintenance
- **Carpool Parking:** Discounted parking for carpool participants

Free Meals & Snacks

In-Office Perks (SF HQ):

- Free breakfast (Mon-Fri, 8:00-9:30 AM)
- Catered lunch (Tuesdays and Thursdays)
- Snacks, coffee, drinks available 24/7

Other Offices:

- Weekly catered lunch
- Snacks and beverages

Remote Employees:

- \$200/month meal stipend (for team lunches, co-working cafe, etc.)

Employee Discounts

Corporate Discounts:

- Apple products (10% discount)
- AT&T, Verizon, T-Mobile (corporate plans)
- Dell, Lenovo, HP (computer equipment)
- Car rentals (Hertz, Enterprise, National)
- Hotels (Marriott, Hilton corporate rates)

Access Discounts:

- Benefits portal: benefits.apextech.com
- Perks at Work program

Backup Childcare**KinderCare Partnership:**

- 10 days/year of backup childcare
- Use when regular care unavailable (sick nanny, school closed, etc.)
- At-home or in-center care
- Subsidized rate: \$25/day (company pays rest)

Pet Insurance**Nationwide Pet Insurance:**

- Discounted group rates
- Coverage for dogs, cats, birds, exotic pets
- Accident, illness, wellness coverage
- Employee-paid (optional benefit)

Company Swag

- Onboarding swag package (laptop bag, hoodie, t-shirts, water bottle)
- Quarterly swag drops (new items)
- Swag store: swag.apextech.com (free credits quarterly)

Volunteer Time Off (VTO)

- **16 hours/year** paid time to volunteer
- Company-sponsored volunteer events quarterly
- Donation matching (up to \$500/year per employee)

Sabbatical Program**After 5 Years:**

- 4-week paid sabbatical
- Encouraged to unplug and recharge
- Manager approval on timing
- Can combine with PTO for extended break

Enrollment & Changes**New Hire Enrollment**

Timeline:

- Benefits overview during onboarding (Week 1)
- Enrollment deadline: **30 days from start date**
- Benefits effective: 1st of month following start date

How to Enroll:

1. Visit benefits.apextech.com
2. Review plan options
3. Select coverage (health, dental, vision, life, disability)
4. Designate beneficiaries (life insurance, 401k)
5. Set up 401(k) contributions
6. Submit enrollment

Need Help?

- Benefits team available: benefits@apextech.solutions
- Office hours: Tuesdays/Thursdays 2-4 PM
- Virtual Q&A; sessions for new hires (check calendar)

Annual Open Enrollment

When: November 1-30 every year

Effective: January 1 (next year)

During Open Enrollment:

- Review and change benefit selections
- Add/remove dependents
- Adjust 401(k) contributions
- Enroll in FSA/HSA (if applicable)

If You Don't Enroll:

Current elections roll over (except FSA—must re-elect annually).

Qualifying Life Events (QLE)**You can change benefits mid-year if you experience:**

- Marriage or divorce
- Birth or adoption of child
- Death of spouse or dependent
- Loss of other coverage
- Change in employment status (full-time to part-time, etc.)

Deadline: **30 days** from event date

How to Make Changes:

1. Submit QLE form via benefits portal
2. Provide documentation (marriage certificate, birth certificate, etc.)
3. HR reviews and approves

4. Changes effective date of event (or first of month following)

COBRA (Continuing Coverage)

If you leave ApexTech:

- Eligible for COBRA continuation (health, dental, vision)
- Duration: Up to 18 months
- Cost: Full premium (company no longer subsidizes) + 2% admin fee
- Enrollment deadline: 60 days from termination

Alternatives to COBRA:

- Healthcare.gov (ACA marketplace)
- Spouse's employer coverage
- Medicaid (if eligible)

COBRA is expensive—explore alternatives first.

Frequently Asked Questions

Q: When do my benefits start?

A: First of the month following your start date (or immediately if you start on the 1st).

Q: Can I waive health insurance?

A: Yes, if you have other coverage (spouse's plan, parent's plan if under 26, etc.). You'll receive a small stipend (~\$100/month) for waiving.

Q: What if I miss the enrollment deadline?

A: You'll have to wait until next open enrollment (or have a qualifying life event). Choose carefully!

Q: How much should I contribute to 401(k)?

A: At minimum, contribute 6% to get full company match (free money!). Ideally, aim for 10-15% total savings rate.

Q: Can I change my 401(k) contribution anytime?

A: Yes! Update via netbenefits.com anytime. Changes take effect next payroll cycle.

Q: What happens to my benefits if I go on leave (parental, medical, etc.)?

A: Benefits continue during paid leave. For unpaid leave, contact HR—you may need to pay your portion of premiums.

Q: Are benefits available for part-time employees?

A: Some benefits yes (401k, pro-rated PTO). Health insurance if working 30+ hours/week. Check with HR.

Q: Can my domestic partner be covered?

A: Yes, if you complete domestic partner affidavit and provide proof of partnership.

Q: What if my spouse also works at ApexTech?

A: You can both enroll in benefits separately, or one can cover both under their plan. Choose what's most cost-effective.

Related Documents

- HR Policies - PTO, sick leave, holidays
- Employee Handbook - Performance reviews, development
- Expense Policy - Professional development reimbursement

Benefits Support

- Email: benefits@apextech.solutions
- Phone: ext. 2150
- Portal: benefits.apextech.com
- Office Hours: Tuesdays/Thursdays, 2:00-4:00 PM (Building A, 2nd Floor)
- Open Enrollment: November 1-30 annually